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Airbnb · Engineering Manager, Identity

San Francisco · Jan 2017 → Present

Lead the team that owns global Identity verification. A platform primitive consumed downstream by Booking, Payments, Trust & Safety, Listings, Risk.

- Hit **100% global verification coverage** across booking guests and listing hosts. The verification waterfall (frictionless → low-friction → high-friction) is country-aware on purpose, optimizing cost and conversion at the same time.
- Lead **19 engineers (FTE + contractors)** across Identity Platform, Identity Defense, and Business Verification. Currently leading the roadmap for NFC, biometrics, Airbnb Passports, and digital wallets.
- Identity Misuse detection: from rule-based heuristics to ML with rules folded in as features. **500+ online features** at ~83K verification events per day. **Precision doubled v1→v2 and lifted another 50% v2→v3**; v4 cut suspension redactions **40%** with no precision loss (~7 hosts/week we used to wrongly suspend who now weren't). Authored the next-generation **Behavioral Trajectory Score**: a self-supervised sequence model that catches the misuse class our image-and-metadata stack misses, designed as a Trust-wide platform.
- **IMQ misuse-appeal volume collapsed ~95%** at scale (~4K/mo down to 100-200), measured against an H1 2022 baseline of ~\$207K/mo in misuse-attributable losses on newly-verified users. The model score also became a **platform signal**, consumed as a feature by the ATO, Chargeback, Fake Account, and Fraud Investigation models.
- **\$23.9M combined annualized impact in 2025**: \$10.6M revenue improvement, \$5.7M fraud mitigation, \$7.6M vendor and operations savings.
- **8 promotions** under direct coaching across my career, not including **3 IC-to-manager transitions** (one of whom I've continued to mentor as an EM to her next promotion). Plus an 18+ month talent-planning horizon and cross-team championing across adjacent teams.

Twitter · Software Engineer

San Francisco · May 2013 → Dec 2016

- Built ad formats that helped advertisers express brand at scale. One optimization on a key format lifted **click-through rate +17%**.
- Led client engineering across Web, Android, and iOS for immersive ad experiences.
- Built Twitter Cards and the framework that rendered them inline in the iOS timeline.

Booyah! · Gameplay Engineer

San Francisco · 2012 – 2013

PlayMesh · iOS Game Developer

Mountain View · 2010 – 2012

Education

M.S. Computer Science · University of Southern California · May 2010

Skills

Leadership

Building teams from zero, succession planning, cross-functional execution at scale.

Marketplace

Verification primitives, KYC, regulatory readiness (DSA), trust & safety, ML in the loop.

Applied AI

Claude API, MCP server design, agent orchestration, evals and guardrails.